Diploma in

UX Design

UX Research

Objectives

- Introduction to UX research
- Investigate research participant selection
- Understand user testing

Introduction to UX research

What is UX research?

- Who is the user?
- What are their needs & goals?
- What designs & options do users find attractive and effective?
- How can functionality be customised?

What is UX research?

- What is the user’s pain point?
- When will the digital product be used?
- What is your user’s technical skill level?
- Are there similar product you can research?
- What are the latest technologies & trends?

Why is UX research important?

Why is UX research important?

Research is conducted by specialists

They still need to be overseen

Implement researchers’ insights into your design

Engaging in research allows you to learn & improve

UX research is a career UX designers can consider

Why is UX research important?

Increase revenue

Save costs

Make rational decisions based on outcomes

Utilise trends before your competition

Benchmark product against competition

Research types

Foundational or generative research

- Performed at beginning
- Learn about the target user
- Product features & opportunities
- Utilised later to learn more about users
- Interviews, surveys, focus groups

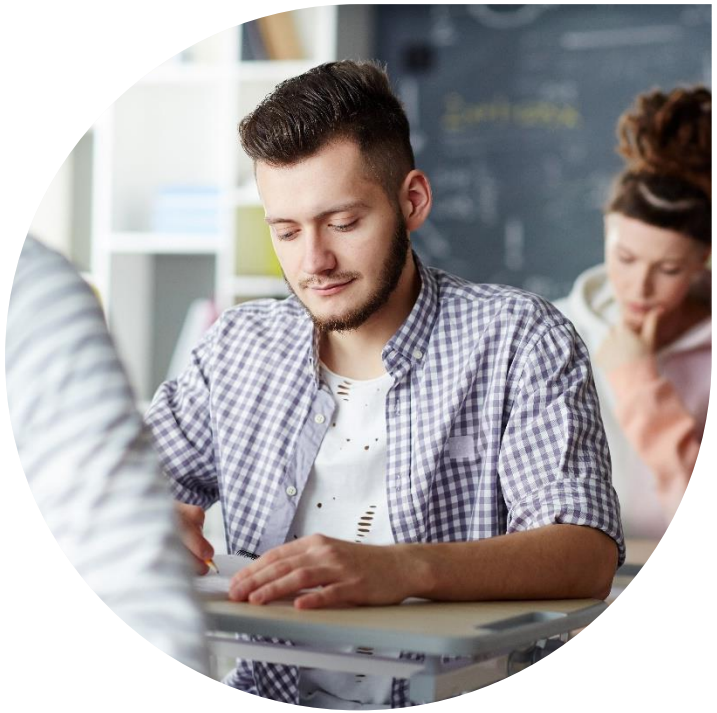
Experimental and evaluative research

- Conducted later during prototyping
- Identify short-term strategies
- Competitor analysis

Did you know?

Only 55% of companies currently conducts UX user testing

Research participant selection



Requirement techniques for user-testing

Criteria for selecting research participants

Criteria for selecting research participants

Similar to your target market

Consider demographics, need, buying habits, career, product usage patterns, experience level, platform used

Test all types of users

Highly interested users provide rich insight

Finding research participants

Finding research participants

Colleagues, friends, family

Recruitment firms

Online user research platforms

Advertisements

Online communities

Special interest organisations

Random selection

Database

Research panels

Snowball recruitment

Screening & scheduling of participants

Screening & scheduling of participants

Asking questions face-to-face

Telephonic interview

Avoid talking about the product, focus on getting the relevant test user

Mention incentives to qualified participants

Arrange time and place for research session

Convenience for participant is more important than convenience for researcher

Incentives to participate

Highly qualified and on-demand professionals can be expensive but people are also happy with a small token of appreciation

in the next lesson

User-testing

User-testing, the most common UX research method

User-testing

Observe user interaction with product

Ask their opinion on the product

User can be anyone representing your target user

Note: test the product, not the user

Moderated or unmoderated

Moderated user test: researcher lead the session. This is the most common UX research technique

Unmoderated user test: automated test where software instructs the user

Venue for user-testing

User-testing venue

Test in a natural, relevant setting

Gym app – test at a gym

No urgency to make use of a ‘usability lab’

Best results in less formal setting

Compulsory user-testing tasks

Compulsory user-testing tasks

User-tests can take a long time

Users can get bored and tired

Prioritise and organise important tasks

Compulsory user-testing tasks

Start with general tasks

Gradually move to more specific tasks

Follow a logical order for tasks

Compulsory user-testing tasks

- Use generic task descriptions
- Avoid being too direct
- Avoid specific words used by the app

Moderation of the user-test

Briefing of the research team

Discuss research purpose, methods, responsibilities and rules

Welcome & brief the participant

Brief the user about the testing procedure and research roles.

Ask user to think out loud.

Moderating during test session

Make the user feel comfortable

Ask user to think out loud

Ask probing question to uncover thoughts

Observe user’s actions

Assist user if struggling with usability

Note down if user struggles with usability

Ask user to rate difficulty of tasks

Post-test questions

Net Promoter Score question

On a scale of 0 to 10

Assess the financial viability of the product

Debrief the participant

Ask if user would consider future research participation

Collect details of willing users

Incentives normally provided after test

Debrief the research team

Capture all insights gained immediately

A user interface is like a joke. If you have to explain it, it's not that good.

- Martin LeBlanc